After eighteen days of searching, the trio's bodies were found dumped in a field outside of Hebron, not far from the kidnapping site. They were buried on 1 July. Their funeral, in their hometown of Modi'in, attracted tens of thousands of people, the crowd spilling beyond the cemetery onto the surrounding hills. The mood was somber, if not angry. Mourners wanted revenge, but were unsure about what form it should take. "We need to send a message, and we need to be sure that [these three] did not die for nothing," said one man, voicing a fairly representative opinion.

Vengeance

Some thirty-six hours later, three Jewish Israelis were cruising the nighttime streets of East Jerusalem in their own white Hyundai, hopped up on cigarettes and energy drinks. "We were hot-headed and angry," the driver later said. They had five large soda bottles filled with gasoline in the car; they doffed their kippahs and donned less conspicuous secular clothing. They were looking for a target—looking to send their own message.

They found one shortly before dawn in Shuafat, a middle-class neighborhood north of the old city: Mohammed Abu Khdair, a slight 16-year-old boy who spoke broken Hebrew. He was outside the local mosque, just steps away from the family home, waiting for his father to finish prayers before *suhoor*, the morning meal before the Ramadan fast begins. "We can overpower him, get out of the car quickly," Yosef Haim Ben-David told his two passengers, both minors. One of them slapped Abu Khdair; the other covered his mouth to stop him from screaming. They forced him into the car and choked him until he lost consciousness.

From Shuafat it was a short drive to the Jerusalem Forest, west of the city, where Ben-David dragged his captive outside and beat him with a crowbar. "This is for the Fogel family; this is for Shalhevet Pass," he shouted, referring to murders carried out by Palestinians in the West Bank in 2011 and 2001, respectively. The three doused him with gasoline. "I took a lighter and I set the boy ablaze," Ben-David concluded. An autopsy would later find that Abu Khdair was still alive when he was set on fire.

Three Jewish teenagers were dead, and now so was a Palestinian teenager, in an act of revenge. Ben-David would later recount the incident for police in chillingly clinical detail. The plot was hatched on 30 June, the night the teens were found dead, when he met with one of his accomplices.